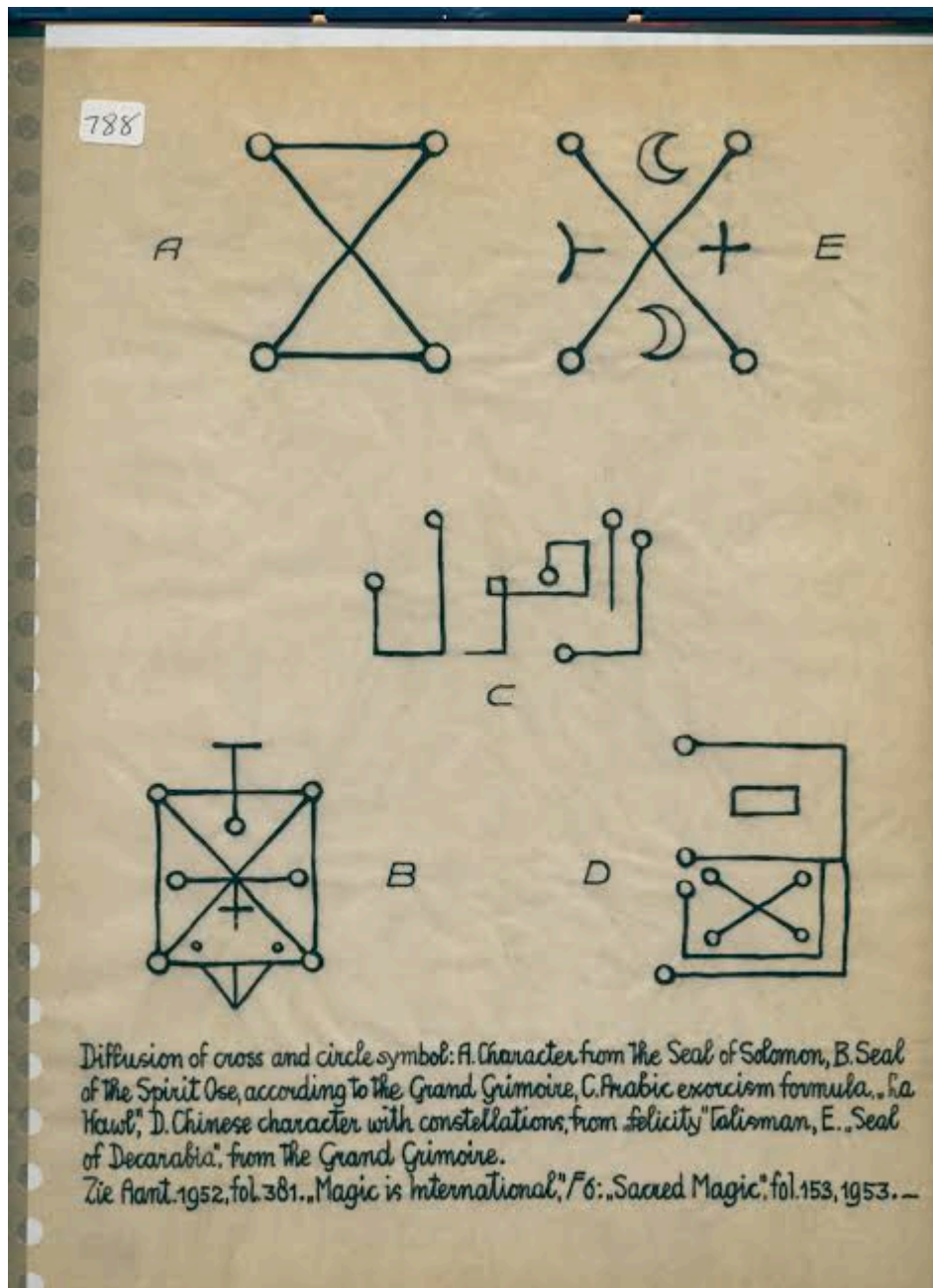


Charaktêres

IMPORTANT!: This guide is still under development (about 85% complete.) but will be completed VERY soon!

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- So... what are Charaktêres (singular: charaktêr)? Well, they're a thing in Graeco-egyptian, jewish, and arabic magic that are letter-shaped signs lacking both semantic and phonetic correlations[1]. In her 2013 thesis Kirsten Dzwiza studied 94 magical texts and recorded 699 different charaktêres occurring over 943 times.[2] The character forms are mostly nonsensical and may include ring-letters, balls, points, closed elements, separate strokes, linear elements, small element, and hieroglyphs.[2] The most common forms consist of asterisks and configurations of straight lines with small circles at their ends.[3] The signs appear mostly on apotropaic spells and phylacteries, but also on a few ancient curse tablets.[1] NOW... how to use them? HMMMMMM??? HUH HUH HUH? WELL... *first, you have to make a charaktêr/charaktêres*. And how? Well. Here is how!:



A example of a charaktêr. Source: The Museum of Witchcraft and Magic

A guide to making charaktêres!

- Draw a shape, here, we'll take two intersecting lines.
- - Now normally, in making a charaktêr, what we do is put a circle on the end point (or the terminal points). The circle should not be big, it should be small (like a node).
- If two lines intersect, what we do is put a node on the intersection.
- If two lines touch to form a sharp corner, put a node there.
- Basically

- ◦ Cap the loose ends/Terminal points
- ◦ Cap the sharp points
- ◦ Cap the intersections
- ◦ That's it

Sources

(a few text has been borrowed from wikipedia but wikipedia's citations are mentioned here and stuff. This is just a guide to making and using Charaktêres.)

1. [György Németh (2020). "Charaktêres on Curse Tablets In the Western Provinces of the Roman Empire". In Gordon, R.; Marco Simón, F.; Piranomonte, M. (eds.). Choosing Magic: Contexts, Objects, Meanings: The Archaeology of Instrumental Religion in the Latin West. De Luca Editori d'Arte. pp. 125–138.]
2. Kirsten Dzwiza (2013). Schriftverwendung in antiker Ritualpraxis anhand der griechischen, demotischen und koptischen Praxisanleitungen des 1. - 7. Jahrhunderts (Thesis). Universität Erfurt.